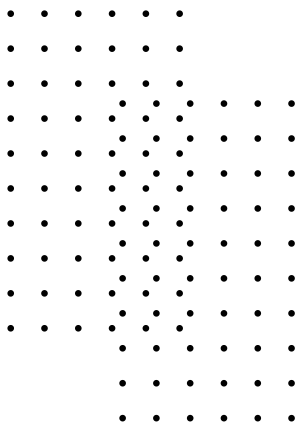


7 Ways to Improve your Communication Skills in English

KEITH O'HARE



Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



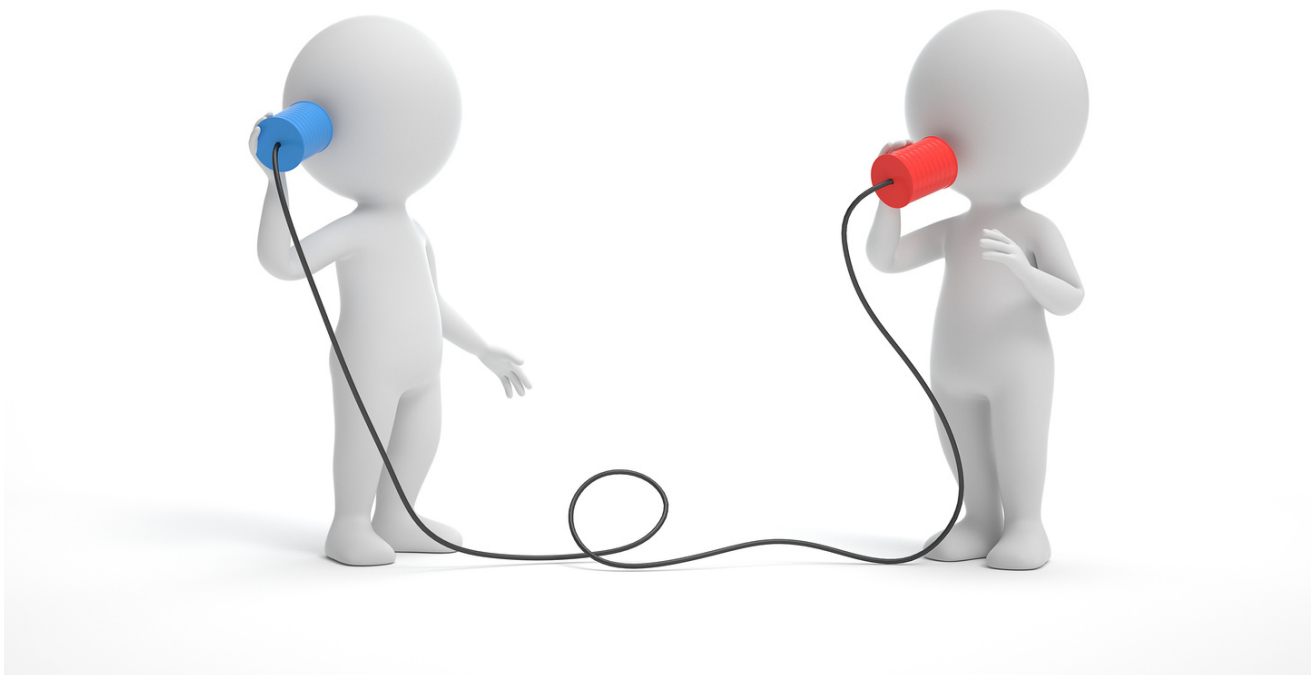
Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

When speaking English, you may know lots of vocabulary and grammar, but still be a terrible communicator.

In order to speak English well and do well on the **IELTS Speaking test**, you will need to improve your communication skills, as well as your language knowledge.

It's important to practice these daily to improve your communication – like confidence, it is a muscle you can develop over time.



COMMUNICATION TIP #1: SPEED

Fluency in English is not determined by your speed, so don't speak too fast. Did you know that effective communicators speak slightly more slowly than normal conversation speed?

Pausing is one of the best things you can do when you are in a speaking situation. It is powerful to pause at the beginning and midway of your speech.

Here are the reasons why:

- **Pausing gives you time to think**
- **Pausing builds trust with the listener**
- **Pausing helps you use effective phrasing – that means using chunks and pauses in the right place**

Let's take the following sentence:

If I had a lot of money, I would purchase a majestic mansion on the rocky coastlines of Spain.

If we break it into chunks it might look like the next example below, with a pause at end of each chunk:

**If I had a lot of money,
I would purchase
a majestic mansion
on the rocky coastlines of Spain**

COMMUNICATION TIP #2: EMPHASIS

Emphasis allows your listeners' attention to fall on the most important part of your speech. By using stress, you can convey and emphasize your message more effectively.

But you need to think about stressing the right

- **Words**
- **Phrases**
- **Ideas**

You can do this with:

1. Adverbs

For example:

If I had a lot of money,
I would definitely purchase a new house

2. Change of Volume

We can increase the volume on the stressed words in a sentence. Also, we can emphasis one part of an idea by putting it at the front of a sentence. Try saying the following phrases, and stress the phrase at the front,

What's _____ about it is....

- **Is Spain an interesting place to live?**

Yes, what's interesting about it is the beautiful scenery

Yes, what's amazing about it is the beautiful scenery

What I _____ about it is....

- **Do you like Spain?**

Yes, what I like about it is...

COMMUNICATION TIP #3: SPEAK CLEARLY

Remember to enunciate your words when you speak so that your listeners can understand you. Open your mouth and speak up!

It's like a bit of exercising muscles in the gym, so don't mumble and let your voice be heard.

One of the most effective methods to improve your communication skill in English is to over-exaggerate when you practice.

Practice doing this in front of a mirror and watch your mouth as you speak and enunciate the words.

Try it out – it can be great fun!

COMMUNICATION TIP #4: SIMPLICITY

There are many differences between spoken and written English.

These differences include:

- **Simpler language**
- **Repetition**

Good communicators generally use simpler language so the listeners can understand them more easily.

Unlike writing and reading, speaking requires us to repeat a lot of words as most of them are lost or forgotten.

Look at the example below.

Written:

If I had a lot of money, I would purchase a majestic mansion on the rocky coastlines of Spain

Spoken:

**If I had a lot of money,
I would buy a huge house
on the coast of Spain**

A ‘majestic mansion’ is poetic while A ‘huge house’ is more natural.

What is the significance of the ‘Rocky coastlines’? In this case, it isn’t important, so it can be left out.

When you learn to speak and listen to your audience, they will pay more attention and it will be easier for you.

Now you can see the importance of simplicity in spoken English.

COMMUNICATION TIP #5: BODY LANGUAGE

When we say Body Language, it includes:

- **eye contact**
- **facial expression**
- **gestures**
- **manner**
- **your smile**

Communication is far more than words. We do communicate a lot without words.

Let's take a look at a video clip below and notice the body language of this first speaker:



[WATCH NOW](#)



**If I had a lot of money,
I would definitely buy a house,
Probably a huge house, on the coast of Spain**

What did you notice?

Now let's see if we can improve it.

Watch the second video clip below and spot the difference.



[WATCH NOW](#)



COMMUNICATION TIP #6: IDEAS

Communication is about getting your idea across. **It's not about speaking perfect English.**

In order to communicate an idea, you need to have an idea to communicate.

If you don't have any ideas, then you have nothing to communicate!
Become an avid reader, watch interesting and varied things e.g.
Curiosity Stream

As part of your practice, ask yourself this question everyday:

What do you think of ____?

Inserting words such as:

- **Science**
- **Modern Art**
- **A.I.**
- **Climate Change**
- **Driverless cars**

You can also make flashcards, each one with this question about a different topic. If you make 20 cards, you can use them to practice your fluency and to develop your ideas.

COMMUNICATION TIP #7: COPY OTHERS

The last tip I have for you to improve your communication skills in English is to copy others.

Spend some time watching great speakers, observe how they communicate and try to imitate everything.

Notice their

- **Speed**
- **Emphasis – volume**
- **Enunciation**
- **Simplicity of language**
- **Body language**
- **Key ideas**

Here are some people you can watch and try imitating their speech:

1. [Barack Obama](#)
2. [Jim Rohn](#)
3. [Oprah Winfrey](#)
4. [Richard Branson](#)
5. [Tony Robbins](#)

Take 2 or 3 of their sentences and mimic them. Record yourself until you sound and look just like them!

Why does 'imitating actors' work?

- **Identity is a key part of language speaking.**
- **When you 'pretend' to be someone else (in this case an English actor), it is sometimes easier to pick up the right pronunciation and intonation.**
- **You stop being you, and become someone else.**

All of this helps to improve your Communication Skills. But wait, there's more! I have a bonus tip for you.

BONUS TIP

The most powerful question great communicators use!

What do you mean exactly?

This question:

- **Makes the other person think you are interested in them and their ideas**
- **Builds trust**

It's also a question you can ask the examiner in the IELTS Speaking test, if you don't fully understand the question (especially in **Part 3**).

I hope this helps you see that good communication is not just about good English. There's so much more to it.

Communication in English is a skill you need to develop, so keep practicing and improve your communication skills in English today.

Find out more about my work at

WWW.KEITHSPEAKINGACADEMY.COM

